

Izzy Escobar — FOH EQ Rationale

Fountain Square (outdoor) · DiGiCo Quantum 225 · 2026-06-26 · Rev 1.0 Deep Build (gear-informed)

Artist. Cuban-Italian pop-soul / indie-R&B; singer-songwriter (debut EP 'Sunny in London', Oct 2025). Classically trained violinist, piano-forward writing, a jazz-and-soul blend with restrained, produced arrangements — violin lines and piano bloom under the voice rather than a wall of band. The voice is the show: Amy-Winehouse throaty grit meets Adele-style soulful power, a wide dynamic range from intimate/breathy to commanding belt. FOH implication: protect the low-mid chest body, ride/compress the intimate->belt swing, keep EQ subtractive and musical, de-ess dynamically rather than statically gutting the air.

Room. Open-air Fountain Square — no room gain, low end and HF both dissipate over the throw, the hard facade can slap but there is no reverb tail. Support the lows and the presence that distance eats, keep cuts surgical, and default to no reverb send (a short, forward plate on the vocal only if a song asks for it).

Research. Artist: Atwood Magazine, commfailure, Ones to Watch, Plastic/Melodic Mag -> pop-soul/jazz/soul, classical-violin roots, piano-forward, restraint over maximalism, Winehouse+Adele vocal reference. Backline (Tech Group quote 26-0553): Yamaha Maple Custom Absolute kit (22in kick w/ Powerstroke 3, 10in+12in racks, 16in floor, Clear/Coated Emperors), Ludwig Black Beauty BRASS snare, Zildjian K Custom cymbals (dark), Fender Deluxe Reverb '65 RI guitar amp, Ampeg SVT-CL + 810 'fridge' bass rig (flatwounds/fingerstyle per stage notes), Yamaha Motif XF8 keys. Per-source EQ cross-checked against live forums (Gearspace, TalkBass, TDPRI, DrumHelper/Sweetwater, maker docs) and the KB eq-starting-points + mic profiles. Venue: open-air Fountain Square.

What changed from the KB default / prior rev — and why

- Guitar (Ch13/14): re-voiced for the ACTUAL amp on the backline quote — a Fender Deluxe Reverb '65 RI — which overrides the 'Vox AC30 top boost' note in the brief. A Deluxe is bright + scooped, so instead of a rock-style 2.5k boost the guitars TAME the bright-cap chime at 3.5k and trim the flubby low end at 150; the mid scoop is left alone (that's the Fender voice).
- Bass (Ch11/12): rig confirmed as Ampeg SVT-CL + 810 'fridge' with flatwounds/fingerstyle — an already-dark, low-mid-heavy sound. So the cab 57 carves a deeper -7@400 pocket and LPFs at 5k, the DI tames clank at 1.5k, and the top stays rolled. Mid-forward soul bass confirmed, not pushed brighter.
- Snare (Ch3): drum confirmed as a brass Ludwig Black Beauty — added a -3@500 to tame its signature metallic ring and big mid projection (a Supraphonic wouldn't need it); the 300 box cut is eased because the BB carries wanted body.
- Overheads + hat (Ch5/9/10): cymbals are dark Zildjian K Customs — pulled the OH air to a modest +2@6k and removed any hat HF lift; a bright EQ on dark cymbals over a long outdoor throw goes washy and brittle.
- Kick (Ch1/2): kit is a 22in maple with a Powerstroke 3 batter — already pre-controlled, so the box cuts are eased and the click leans on the 91A rather than EQ.
- Vocal (Ch25): static -5@8k -> dynamic de-ess and HPF 130->110 — the KMS 105 isn't a sibilant mic, so protect the throaty chest body and only de-ess on peaks.
- Acoustic (Ch15): air moved off the 5k brassy-piezo zone up to 8k, and the 2k piezo quack cut made dynamic so it only bites on loud strums.

DRUMS

Ch 1 | Kick In · Shure Beta 91A

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 +4@3.5 kHz Q1.2 BELL B3 -2@600 Hz Q2 BELL B2 -3@300 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 +3@80 Hz Q1.2 BELL

Boundary mic inside a 22in maple kick with a Powerstroke 3 batter — the head is already muffled/focused, and the 91A is the attack/click layer.

The 91A owns the click — +4@3.5k beater definition that travels outdoors. Lows modest so they tuck under the 52A; box cut eased to -3 because the Powerstroke 3 + maple shell are already controlled, no need to gut 250.

Ch 2 | Kick Out · Shure Beta 52A

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 +2@3 kHz Q1.2 BELL B3 -2@600 Hz Q2 BELL B2 -3@300 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 +5@70 Hz Q1.2 BELL

52A at the port = the body/weight engine of the maple kick.

+5@70 supports the weight open air swallows; only a small 3k snap since the 91A carries the real click. Mud cut eased for outdoors.

Ch 3 | Snare Top · Audix i5

HPF 120 | LPF off || B4 +2@7 kHz Q0.8 BELL B3 +3@1 kHz Q1 BELL B2 -3@500 Hz Q2 BELL B1 -4@300 Hz Q2 BELL

i5 has a built-in ~3.5-4k presence peak and slightly scooped low-mids — fuller, less boxy than a 57. The drum is a brass Ludwig Black Beauty: dark, with a strong metallic ring and big mid projection.

On a Black Beauty the ring is the thing to manage — -3@500 tames the metallic ring/projection without gutting the drum (a Supraphonic wouldn't need this). -4@300 box, eased because the brass carries wanted body. +3@1k restores the crack the i5 scoops; +2@7k snap for the outdoor throw — coated Emperor + i5 presence mean it doesn't need more.

Ch 5 | Hat · Shure SM81

HPF 500 | LPF 16000 || B4 flat B3 flat B2 -4@2 kHz Q1.2 BELL B1 -6@800 Hz Q1.5 BELL

SM81 — smooth, un-hyped highs. The hats are 14in Zildjian K Custom Session: dark and warm, not bright.

No HF boost — dark K hats through a smooth 81 already sit nicely, and lifting the top over a long outdoor throw just adds hiss. Clear the low bleed (800) and the 2k clang; LPF 16k trims any edge.

Ch 6 | Rack 1 · Audix D2

HPF 100 | LPF 12000 || B4 flat B3 +4@3 kHz Q1 BELL B2 -3@450 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 +3@150 Hz Q1.2 BELL

D2 is tuned to control tom resonance — articulate with little EQ. This is the 10in rack (highest tom), Clear Emperor.

Voiced highest in the kit series. Gentle body @150, modest mud cut @450, +4@3k stick attack — trust the D2's voicing.

Ch 7 | Rack 2 · Audix D2

HPF 85 | LPF 12000 || B4 flat B3 +4@2.6 kHz Q1 BELL B2 -3@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 +3@130 Hz Q1.2 BELL

As Rack 1, shifted down for the larger 12in drum.

Same treatment as Rack 1, voiced a touch lower for the bigger shell — let the D2 do the work.

Ch 8 | Floor · Audix D4

HPF 55 | LPF 10000 || B4 flat B3 +4@1.8 kHz Q1 BELL B2 -3@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 +4@70 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

D4 reaches an octave lower than the D2 natively — the 16in floor's weight is there without much help.

Body shelf stays modest (+4) — support, not a big lift; ride the sub outdoors. -3@400 mud; +4@1.8k stick definition.

Ch 9 | OH HL · Shure SM81

HPF 180 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 +2@6 kHz Q0.8 BELL B1 -5@300 Hz Q1.5 BELL

Cymbal sheen + kit glue. The cymbals are dark Zildjian K Customs; the SM81 is already detailed.

+2@6k only (not +5) — dark K cymbals plus a long outdoor throw mean a big HF lift turns brittle and washy. -5@300 clears the low wash so the OHs stay cymbals, not a second kit mic.

Ch 10 | OH HR · Shure SM81

HPF 180 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 +2@6 kHz Q0.8 BELL B1 -5@300 Hz Q1.5 BELL

Matched to OH HL — keep the stereo pair identical.

Same as OH HL.

RHYTHM

Ch 11 | Bass DI · XLR (DI)

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 -5@1.5 kHz Q1.5 BELL B3 +4@600 Hz Q1 BELL B2 -6@250 Hz Q2 BELL B1 +5@80 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

DI carries the lows the sealed 810 rolls off. Flatwounds + fingerstyle = dark, round, low-mid forward, very little string clank.

Soul/Motown bass — dark, round, low-mid forward, top rolled. +4@600 is the Motown 'wool'; -5@1.5k tames what little clank there is (flats are already dark); -6@250 keeps it off the kick AND the cab's strong low-mids; +5@80 foundation for the open air.

Ch 12 | Bass Mic · Shure SM57

HPF 60 | LPF 5000 || B4 flat B3 +5@800 Hz Q1 BELL B2 -7@400 Hz Q2 BELL B1 +5@100 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

57 on the 810 cab — it's the punch/grind mid layer over the DI (the 57 rolls off below ~200). The sealed 810 is already strong in the low-mids and has no top sizzle.

+5@800 is the SVT growl; -7@400 carves a deep pocket so it doesn't stack the DI AND the 810's baked low-mid into mud. LPF 5k keeps the dark flatwound character — the fridge has no top anyway. Blend constant with the DI, same VCA.

Ch 13 | Guitar 57 · Shure SM57

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 -4@3.5 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 +2@800 Hz Q1.2 BELL B2 -3@400 Hz Q2 BELL B1 -3@150 Hz Q1.2 BELL

57 brings honky mids; the amp is a Fender Deluxe Reverb '65 — bright-cap chime, scooped mids, a snappy/glassy top that turns ice-picky past ~5 on the dial. The treble is the thing to tame, not boost.

Re-voiced for the actual amp (Deluxe Reverb '65 from the backline quote — overrides the 'Vox AC30' note in the brief). A Deluxe is bright and scooped, so instead of a rock-style 2.5k push this TAMES the chime at 3.5k, trims the flubby low end at 150, and adds just a touch of body at 800 so the clean tone sits under the vocal. The mid scoop is left alone — that's the Fender voice.

Ch 14 | Guitar 27 · Shure Beta 27

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +2@10 kHz Q0.8 BELL B3 -3@3.5 kHz Q1.4 BELL B2 -2@400 Hz Q2 BELL B1 +2@120 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

Bright detailed condenser — on a bright Deluxe its value is clean low body + a hint of air, NOT more upper-mid, which would just stack the amp's chime.

Re-thought from the KB condenser default: 57 owns mids, 27 owns clean body + a sliver of air. Because the Deluxe is already bright, the 27's presence region (3.5k) is trimmed, not boosted, and the air sits up at 10k above the ice-pick zone. -2@400 to match a little box; same VCA as the 57.

Ch 15 | Acoustic Guitar · BSS AR-133

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +3@8 kHz Q0.71 SHELF B3 -6@2 kHz Q1.8 BELL +DEQ B2 -5@400 Hz Q2 BELL B1 +4@200 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

AR-133 is a clean/transparent DI; the source is a piezo — quack at 1.5-2k, brassy at ~5k.

Air at 8k, NOT 5k — 5k is the brassy piezo zone you cut. The -6@2k quack cut is DYNAMIC so it only bites on loud strums without gutting sustain; -5@400 box; +4@200 body the piezo can't make on its own.

Ch 17 | Keys · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 50 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 +2@8 kHz Q0.71 SHELF B2 +3@2.5 kHz Q0.8 BELL B1 -4@200 Hz Q1.5 BELL

Motif XF8 is a full-range workstation — real piano lows and it can be bright; clean DI. Piano is central to her writing.

HPF only 50 to keep the piano's real low end. Carve -4@200 so it doesn't crowd the bass + vocal low-mids; +3@2.5k for definition in a dense mix; a gentle 8k shelf for sparkle. Musical, not hyped — the Motif is already full and produced.

Ch 18 | Click · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 80 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 -4@315 Hz Q2 BELL B1 -2@200 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

Utility / cue.

Mud trimmed so it's clean in the players' ears. CONFIRM: monitors / IEM only — never to FOH.

Ch 19 | Guide · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 80 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 -4@315 Hz Q2 BELL B1 -2@200 Hz Q0.71 SHELF

Guide vocal / cue track.

Same utility treatment. CONFIRM: monitors / IEM only — not in FOH.

Ch 20 | Tracks · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 30 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 flat B1 flat

Already a balanced, mastered master — not a mic'd source.

Left near-flat (HPF 30 only) — EQ'ing a finished master like a mic'd source just thins the production. Add a small 315 trim live ONLY if it clouds the band.

VOCALS

Ch 25 | Izzy · Neumann KMS 105

HPF 110 | LPF 15000 || B4 -3@7.5 kHz Q3 BELL +DEQ B3 -3@1.6 kHz Q1.4 BELL B2 -4@300 Hz Q2 BELL B1 flat

KMS 105 — transparent, smooth 7-12k presence, NOT a sibilant mic. Wired handheld on a stand.

The show lives here. A DYNAMIC de-ess at 7.5k instead of a static -5@8k — keep the air a soul voice wants and only act on sibilant peaks. HPF pulled to 110 (the mic compensates proximity, won't boom) to protect the throaty Winehouse chest body. -3@1.6k gentle nasal; -4@300 box for outdoor intelligibility. Protective + subtractive, not aggressive. NOTE: this overrides the FSQ template's wireless-vocal baseline (removes its feedback notch) — watch for feedback at soundcheck and reach for the Mustard comp + a touch of plate before any more EQ.